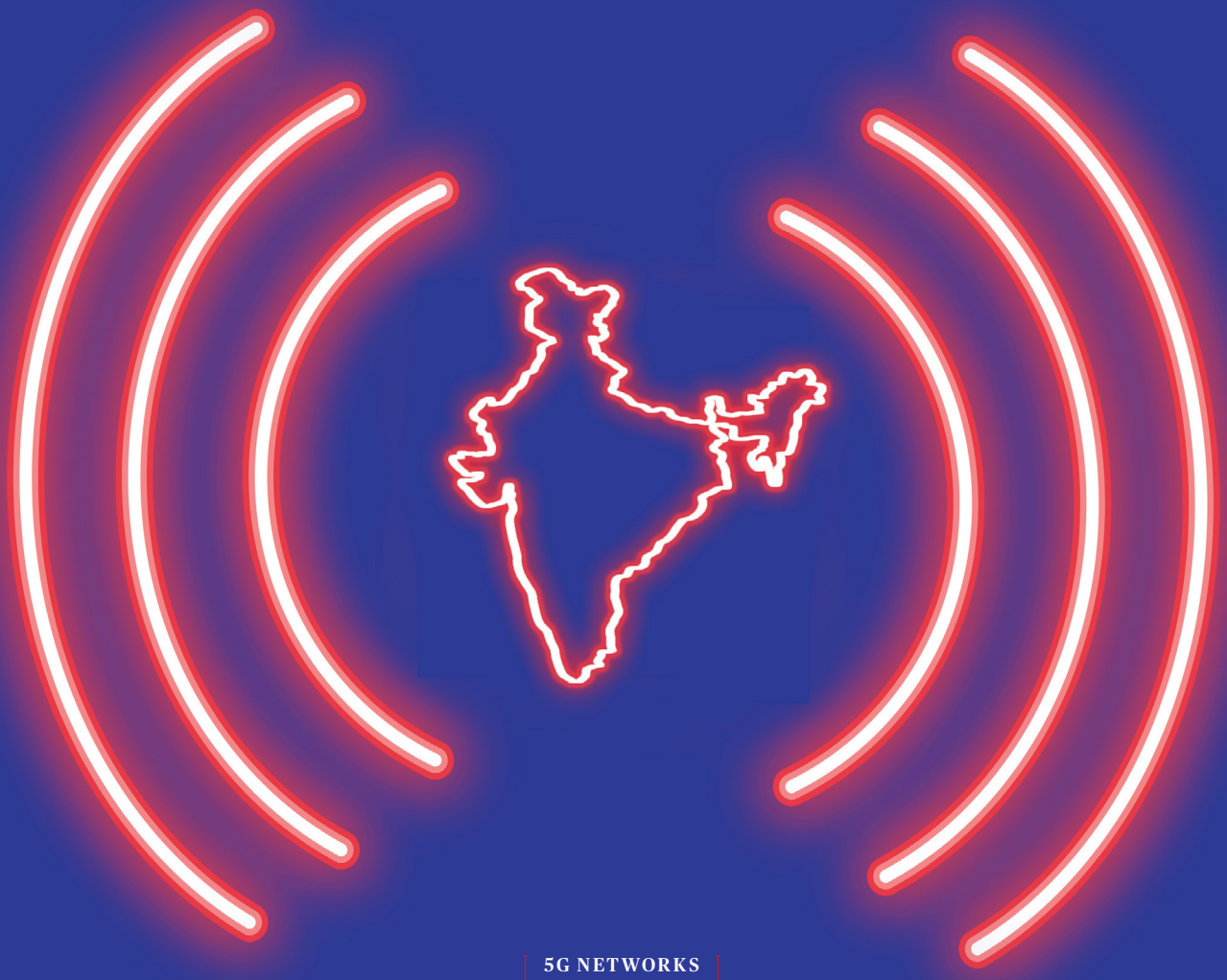
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5G NETWORKS

## REDEFINING REAL TIME

By M.G. Arun

Imagine being able to watch a live cricket match on your mobile phone in real time with no lag (or 'network latency')—or being able to do so while travelling from one end of your city to another with no disruption. Should India's telcos see a trouble-free rollout of their 5G networks, that might well become a reality in the country. For now, the Centre's DoT (Department of Telecommunications) has allotted test spectrum to various companies for testing and validation of their technologies, and plans to conduct auctions for 5G spectrum by July.

According to the DoT, 5G will at first be made available in 13 cities across India in 2022—Delhi, Gurugram, Bengaluru, Kolkata, Mumbai, Chandigarh, Jamnagar, Ahmedabad, Chennai, Hyderabad, Lucknow, Pune and Gandhinagar. India's three top telcos—Reliance Jio, Airtel and Vodafone Idea—have already set up 5G trial sites in some cities to ensure they are war-ready to use the spectrum and infrastructure (optic fibre cables, etc.) that is to be brought online this year.

Reliance Jio, India's largest cellular operator, with 429.5 million

*Illustration by* NILANJAN DAS